

Per-service toggles for agents daemon

Add independent enable/disable toggles for every daemon-hosted service, make the secrets broker disableable with a clear error, and expose the toggles through agents daemon services enable|disable <service>.

phnx-labs/agents-cli · feat/daemon-services · RUSH-XXXX · Kimi · Muqsit · yosemite-s0 · 141ec99e · 2026-08-10

01 Purpose

`agents daemon` already exists on `main` (RUSH-2354): it has `status`, `start`, `stop`, `restart`, `enable`, `disable`, `reload`, `services`, `logs`, and `doctor`. What is missing is independent control of the services the daemon hosts.

The daemon currently runs all of these unconditionally:

- secrets broker (+ broker self-heal)
- routines scheduler + catchup
- monitor engine
- browser IPC server
- self-heal registry
- keychain reap
- account-state service (usage refresh + fleet-status publish)
- watchdog
- device probe
- state-dir self-check

When the secrets broker misbehaves and causes a Touch ID storm, there is no kill switch. This change adds a per-service toggle so any hosted service can be disabled, and callers get a clear error instead of a silent fallback.

Proposed: each daemon service is independently toggleable

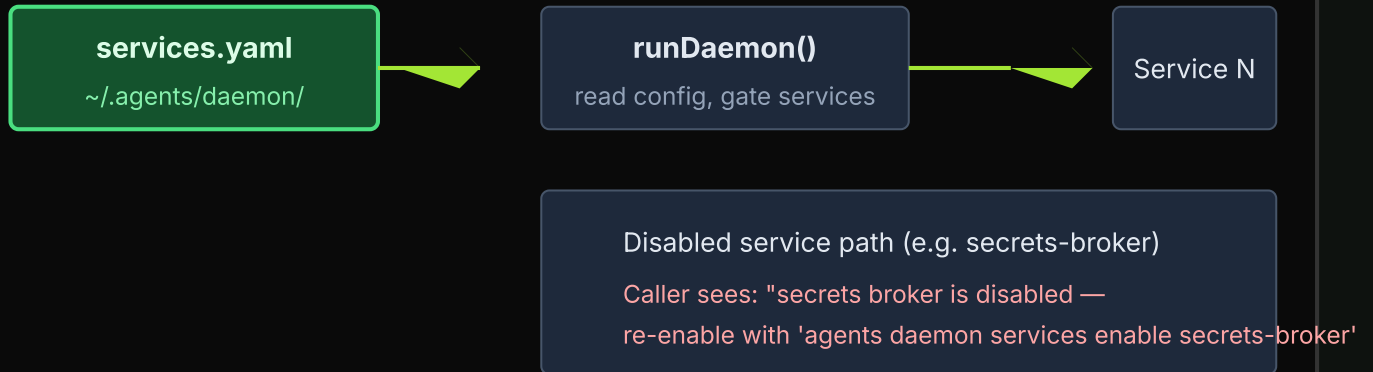


Figure 1: Config-driven service gating and clear disabled-service errors.

Load-bearing takeaway: Disabling a service must stop the daemon from running it and must make callers fail with an actionable message — never silently fall back to Touch ID or another worse path.

02 Current state (after pulling latest main)

- `apps/cli/src/commands/daemon.ts` — full daemon command tree already exists.
- `apps/cli/src/commands/daemon.test.ts` — tests exist.
- `apps/cli/src/lib/daemon.ts` — `runDaemon()` starts all services unconditionally.
- `apps/cli/src/lib/device-config.ts` — `daemon.enabled` and `scheduler.enabled` already exist as device-config gates.
- Recent refactor [dd2043848](#) (RUSH-2495) removed the maintenance-routine layer; watchdog and device-probe are now plain daemon timers.

03 Proposed Changes

1. Add a service config file and loader

Create `apps/cli/src/lib/daemon-services.ts`:

- Stable service IDs.

- Human titles + descriptions.
- Config path: `~/.agents/daemon/services.yaml`.
- Helpers: `readDaemonServicesConfig()`, `isDaemonServiceEnabled(id)`, `setDaemonServiceEnabled(id, enabled)`.

Initial catalog (all default to `true`):

```
services:
  secrets-broker: true
  scheduler: true
  monitors: true
  browser-ipc: true
  self-heal: true
  keychain-reap: true
  account-state: true
  watchdog: true
  device-probe: true
  state-dir-check: true
```

Only explicit `false` disables. Missing file or missing key means enabled.

2. Extend `agents daemon services` with enable/disable

Add subcommands:

```
agents daemon services list          # existing + toggle state
agents daemon services enable <id>
agents daemon services disable <id>
```

Keep `agents daemon services` (no args) as the health-only view.

3. Gate services inside `runDaemon()`

Read the service config at startup. For each disabled service:

- Skip its initialization.
- Skip its timer/interval.
- Skip its self-heal loop.

On `SIGHUP` reload, apply scheduler and secrets-broker toggles immediately where feasible; for other services, log that a restart is required to apply a toggle change.

4. Make secrets broker disablement fail loudly

When `secrets-broker` is disabled:

- Daemon does not call `startHostedBroker()` and does not run `runBrokerSelfHeal()`.
- The secrets fast-path client reads the service config. If disabled, it returns a disabled verdict.
- `agents secrets` commands surface: `Secrets broker is disabled – re-enable with 'agents daemon services enable secrets-broker'`.
- This prevents the Touch ID fallback storm.

04 Public Interface

New commands

COMMAND	BEHAVIOR
<code>agents daemon services list</code>	Lists every hosted service, its enabled/disabled state, and description.
<code>agents daemon services enable <id></code>	Enables a service.
<code>agents daemon services disable <id></code>	Disables a service.

Config file

`~/.agents/daemon/services.yaml` holds per-service booleans.

Disabled-service error

For secrets broker specifically:

Secrets broker is disabled – re-enable with 'agents daemon services enable secrets-broker'

05 Validation

- Unit tests for `lib/daemon-services.ts`: defaults, read/write toggles, unknown IDs ignored.

- Tests for `agents daemon services list|enable|disable`.
- Test that disabling `secrets-broker` makes `agents secrets` fail with the expected message.
- Existing `daemon.test.ts` and `routines.test.ts` still pass.
- Run `bun run test:remote` or local suite and fix failures.

06 Risks

RISK	MITIGATION
A service is accidentally disabled by default.	Default every known service to <code>true</code> ; only explicit <code>false</code> disables.
Secrets broker disabled state leaks to non-daemon paths.	Check config inside <code>ensureAgentRunning()</code> ; align with <code>AGENTS_SECRETS_NO_AGENT=1</code> .
<code>__daemon-run</code> behavior changes.	Only gate what happens after <code>runDaemon()</code> starts.
Single-instance guarantee breaks.	Do not touch <code>claimDaemonInstance()</code> , locks, pid file, or heartbeat logic.
Watchdog/device-probe toggle confusion with existing device-config flags.	Keep existing <code>watchdog.enabled</code> as the activity gate; the service toggle controls whether the timer runs at all.

07 Tracking

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- Add `getDaemonConfigDir()` path helper in `state.ts`.
- Create `lib/daemon-services.ts` catalog + config loader.
- Extend `commands/daemon.ts` with `services enable|disable|list`.
- Gate services in `runDaemon()`.
- Wire secrets-broker disabled check into `lib/secrets/agent.ts` and `commands/secrets.ts`.
- Update tests.
- Update docs and CHANGELOG.
- Run tests and verify.